

Mill Valley CA PD Transparency Portal

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individual privacy. The Department uses retroactive searches to aid in solving crimes after they occur and leverages real-time alerts for hotlisted vehicles to help apprehend wanted individuals. To promote transparency and accountability, the Department has made its policies and usage statistics publicly available.

Community Impact

Featured Success Stories

Success Story - January 5, 2026

On January 5, 2026, a resident reported that their vehicle had been vandalized sometime between December 24 and December 25, 2025, resulting in significant damage. During the investigation, officers developed suspect information. Using the Flock Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) system, the investigating officer identified additional investigative leads and confirmed that the suspect's vehicle entered the City of Mill Valley during the early morning hours of December 25. The information obtained through the ALPR system helped corroborate the investigation and contributed to the identification of the suspect. As a result, the suspect was ultimately charged with felony vandalism.

Success Story - January 10, 2026

On January 10, 2026, a Mill Valley retailer reported that an individual had rented two high-value electric mountain bicycles earlier that day and failed to return them as agreed. Prior to contacting the Police Department, the reporting party made multiple unsuccessful attempts to contact the renter. During the investigation, officers used the Flock Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) system to develop investigative leads based on the description of the stolen bicycles, which had been transported on a bicycle rack affixed to the suspect vehicle. After identifying the suspect vehicle, investigators collaborated with allied law enforcement agencies throughout the Bay Area to identify the individual responsible for the thefts. As a result of the investigation, the suspect was ultimately charged with grand theft and burglary.

On January 21, 2026, a separate Mill Valley retailer reported that an individual had rented a high-value electric mountain bicycle on January 10, 2026, and failed to return it. During the investigation of the earlier January 10 incident, officers had observed through Flock ALPR images that the suspect vehicle was transporting three bicycles, despite only two bicycles having been reported stolen at that time. The subsequent January 21 report accounted for the third bicycle observed in the ALPR images and confirmed that the same suspect was responsible for both incidents. As a result, the suspect was charged with an additional count of grand theft and burglary.

Success Story - January 11, 2026

On January 11, 2026, a resident reported that their mountain bicycle had been stolen from the 500 block of E. Blithedale Avenue. The bicycle was described as having a distinctive bright yellow paint scheme. The responding officer recalled observing a white SUV in the area shortly before the start of their work shift because it was carrying a bright yellow mountain bicycle on the roof of the vehicle.

Given the vehicle's proximity to the location of the theft and the timing of the observation, the officer believed it could be associated with the crime. Investigators used the Flock Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) system to locate additional sightings of the suspect vehicle, despite the vehicle not displaying license plates. The resulting investigative leads indicated the vehicle frequently traveled in the Santa Rosa area. Investigators shared this information with allied law enforcement agencies, including the Santa Rosa and Petaluma Police Departments, which led to additional investigative efforts.

Through this collaborative investigation, officers identified and arrested the suspect for grand theft and recovered the victim's stolen bicycle.

Success Story - February 6, 2026

On February 6, 2026, a resident reported that a person associated with a vehicle on Hamilton Drive had attempted to assault and kidnap them. Based on the information available at the time, responding officers developed probable cause to believe the occupant of a Toyota sedan may have been involved in the reported crime. Using the Flock Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) system, investigators identified a vehicle matching the reported description that had been in the vicinity of the incident at the relevant time. The vehicle information was shared with allied law enforcement agencies throughout the Bay Area, and officers were subsequently notified that the vehicle had been located in San Jose. The suspect was detained and arrested based on the information available during the initial stages of the investigation.

While the suspect was being transported and processed, investigators continued to gather additional evidence, including surveillance video from the surrounding area. After further investigation, the arrested individual was subsequently released without charges.

Although the investigation ultimately determined that no crime had been committed, the incident demonstrates how the Flock ALPR system enabled investigators to quickly identify and locate a vehicle associated with a serious reported offense while the investigation remained active.

Success Story - May 20, 2026

On May 20, 2026, Mill Valley officers were dispatched following a Flock Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) alert indicating that a reported stolen vehicle had entered the City via Miller Avenue. Officers immediately began searching the area and located the vehicle in the parking lot of a business on Miller Avenue. After confirming that the vehicle had been reported stolen and remained outstanding, officers contacted an individual as they returned to the vehicle. Following the investigation, the individual was arrested for possession of a stolen vehicle.

Success Story - May 28, 2026

On May 28, 2026, Mill Valley officers responded to a report of a hit-and-run collision in the downtown area. During the investigation, officers learned that the suspect had collided with several parked vehicles and a building before fleeing the scene without stopping to report the collisions. Investigators developed suspect information, including a vehicle description and license plate number. A custom Flock Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) "hotlist" was created for the suspect vehicle to notify officers if it reentered the City. On May 30, 2026, officers received an alert that the suspect vehicle had entered Mill Valley. Responding officers located the vehicle, contacted the suspect, and ultimately arrested them for hit-and-run.

Success Story - May 29, 2026

On May 29, 2026, a Mill Valley retailer reported that an employee had just stolen merchandise from the business and left the area in a vehicle. During the investigation, officers identified the suspect's vehicle and used the Flock Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) system to develop investigative leads regarding the vehicle's recent location. ALPR data indicated that the suspect vehicle had recently been in the area of Redwood Highway Frontage Road. Responding officers located the suspect in that area, contacted them, and ultimately arrested them for theft and embezzlement.

Success Story - July 11, 2026

On July 11, 2026, officers were dispatched to Carmelita Avenue for a report of a hit-and-run collision that had just occurred. Although the victim provided a description of the suspect vehicle and a license plate number, investigators determined that the reported license plate was incorrect. Using the Flock Automated License Plate Reader (ALPR) system, the investigating officer identified the vehicle involved in the collision and subsequently identified the individual who had been driving the vehicle at the time of the incident. As a result of the investigation, the case was submitted to the Marin County District Attorney's Office with a recommendation that the driver be charged with hit-and-run.

Data & Usage Summary

Data Retention

The number of days data is retained.

> **7 days**

Total Cameras

Number of LPR and other cameras.

> **10**

LPR Cameras

Number of LPR cameras only.

> **6**

Unique Vehicles Detected

Number of unique plate reads over the last 30 days.

> **0**

Number of Searches

Total user search sessions over the last 30 days.

> **3**

Hotlists Alerted On

National and statewide hotlist sources.

> California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

Number of Hotlist Hits

Total hotlist hits over the last 30 days.

> **Data Unavailable**

Sharing Network Data With

Organizations granted access to Mill Valley CA PD data.

- Belvedere CA PD
- Marin County CA DA
- Marin County CA SO
- Palo Alto CA PD
- Sausalito CA PD

Policy & Trust

What's Detected

> License Plates, Vehicles

What's Not Detected

> Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race

Acceptable Use Policy

> Data is used for law enforcement purposes only. Data is owned by Mill Valley CA PD and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Prohibited Uses

> Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement, harassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), Personal use.

Access Policy

> All system access requires a valid search reason per Mill Valley Police Department ALPR Policy 429.

Hotlist Policy

> Hotlist hits are required to be human verified prior to action.

More Info

Live Feed Data retention (in days)

> 3 days

MVPD ALPR Policy:

> https://www.cityofmillvalley.gov/DocumentCenter/View/12149/MVPD-ALPR-Policy-429

MVPD Public Safety Video Surveillance System Policy:

> https://www.cityofmillvalley.gov/DocumentCenter/View/12263/MVPD-Policy-340

MVPD Flock Safety ALPR and Camera Use Information and Public FAQ

> https://cityofmillvalley.gov/DocumentCenter/View/11507/FLOCK-for-City-Council-RN3

Provided by Flock Safety